

CHOMP

A coach for the 30 seconds before a Pokémon match

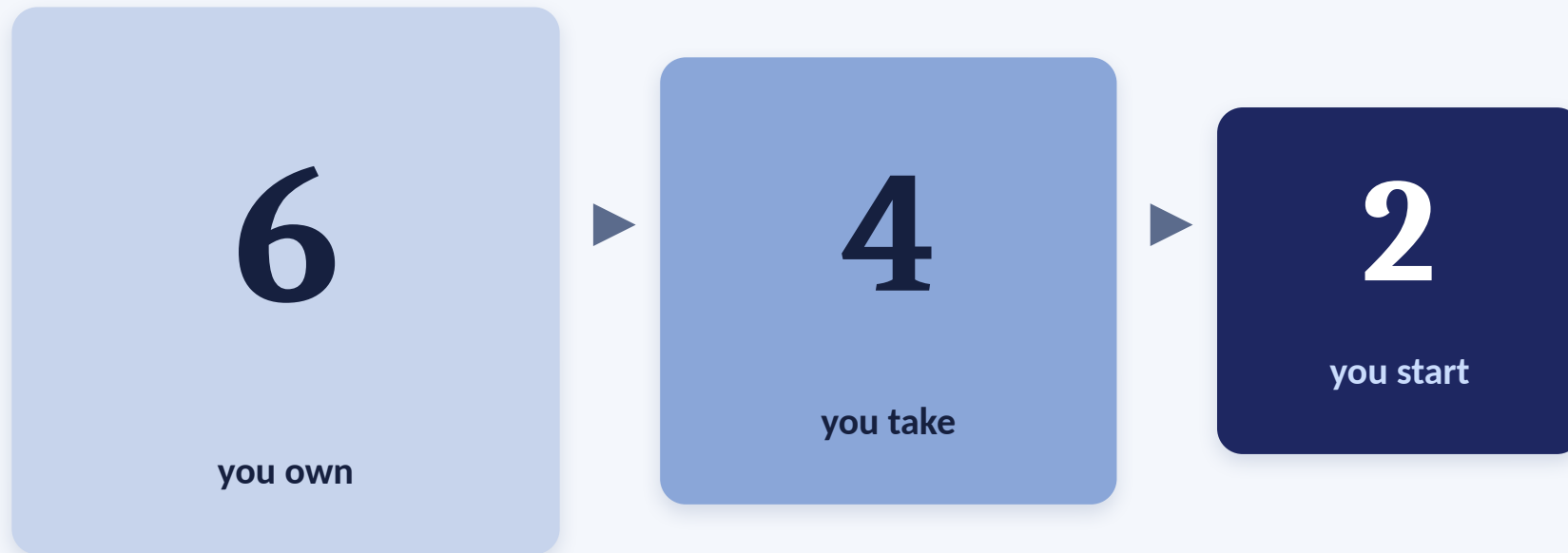
How a computer picks a better team than a gut feeling — explained in plain English

PLAIN ENGLISH

willhoop · July 2026

Every match starts with one rushed decision

You build a team of six Pokémon. But you only take four into the match, and only two start on the field. You choose — while a clock runs down.



Pick well and you are ahead before the first move. Pick badly and the match is decided already.

More possible teams than atoms you can count

10¹³⁹

possible team combinations

That is more than chess, Go, poker, StarCraft and Dota put together.



You cannot see their cards

You never learn the opponent's exact moves or items until they use them.



You both move at once

There is no "best" answer — only better odds against what they might do.



The clock is running

About 30 seconds. No time to work it out by hand.

Replace the gut feeling with arithmetic

How players decide today

- "Fire beats grass, so I'll bring this one."
- Rules of thumb learned from experience.
- No time to check whether an attack actually knocks the target out.
- Easy to miss that the weather is quietly draining your team.

How CHOMP decides

-  **Does this attack actually knock it out?**
It runs the real damage formula from the game.
-  **How likely is it?**
Damage varies. It counts all 16 possible outcomes.
-  **What is the weather doing?**
Sandstorm quietly chips your team every turn.
-  **Who moves first?**
Speed, items and abilities all change the order.

Four steps, finished before you can read them

1

Read both teams

It sees your six and their six
the moment the match opens.

2

Guess their gear

It assumes the moves and
items most players actually
use.

3

Do the maths

It calculates every attack
against every target — 24
matchups.

4

Give the answer

It names the four to take and
the two to start.

The whole calculation finishes in under a twentieth of a second, on your own computer.

DOES IT WORK

A real mistake it now catches

Before

Lost twice to sandstorm teams

A sandstorm damages most Pokémon every single turn. Two of mine were immune to it — and I left both on the bench, twice.

After

It names them, and says why

“Bring Archaludon and Kingambit — 2 of your team are being worn down by their sandstorm.”

1323

highest ranking reached

154%

damage it calculates exactly, not guesses

0.05s

to answer

What it does not do

1

It does not play the match

It advises on the opening choice only. After that, you play.

2

It guesses the opponent's gear

Those guesses come from what most players use. Someone unusual can beat the guess.

3

It looks one move ahead

It does not yet follow a match several turns forward.

4

It always gives the same answer

A sharp opponent could learn the pattern over time.

THE BOTTOM LINE

A rushed guess, turned into arithmetic.

It reads both teams, does the real damage maths, and tells you which four to bring and which two to start — before the clock matters.

Full technical detail and the mathematics:

[CHOMP White Paper — docs/CHOMP-whitepaper.md](#)